



Incident handler's journal

Date: 29/09/2026	Entry 1: Phishing Playbook
Description	This entry documents the investigation of a phishing email alert (Ticket A-2703) containing a malicious attachment. This occurred during the Detection and Analysis phase of the NIST lifecycle, as the primary goal was to analyze phishing indicators, verify the malware hash, and escalate for immediate containment.
Tool(s) used	Phishing Playbook, Alert Ticket system
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: An unknown attacker spoofing the sender name "Clyde West" from a suspicious address (76tguyhh6tgfrt7tg.su / IP: 114.114.114.114) targeted the HR department at Inergy (hr@inergy.com / IP: 176.157.125.93). • What: A phishing email disguised as a job application for an "Infrastructure Egnieer" role. The email contained noticeable spelling errors and a password-protected executable malware file (bfsvc.exe) masquerading as a resume. • When: The incident occurred on Wednesday, July 20, 2022, at 09:30:14 AM. • Where: The attack was delivered via the company's email server (SERVER-MAIL) to an employee's inbox. • Why: The attacker intended to deceive the HR employee into entering the provided password (paradise10789) to bypass security scanners,

	execute the malicious file, and infect the company's system with malware.
Additional notes	The ticket was escalated due to multiple critical phishing indicators and the presence of the verified malicious file hash.

Date: 29/09/2026	Entry 2: VirusTotal
Description	This entry documents the investigation of a suspicious file hash using VirusTotal to identify Indicators of Compromise (IoCs) and categorize them using the Pyramid of Pain model during the Detection and Analysis phase.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal (OSINT tool)
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: A security analyst investigating a potential malware infection. • What: Analyzed a SHA256 file hash and explicitly identified it as Flagpro malware. • When: During the initial triage of a suspicious file download alert. • Where: Utilizing the VirusTotal web-based platform to analyze file behavior. • Why: To understand the malware's characteristics, identify its command and control (C2) infrastructure, and gather actionable artifacts to defend the network.
Additional notes	I successfully mapped the discovered IoCs to the Pyramid of Pain. Key findings include the malicious domain (org.misecure.com), associated IP address (207.148.109.242), and the TTP of Command and Control (C2).

Date: 29/09/2026	Entry 3: Packet
Description	This entry documents the process of analyzing network traffic and inspecting individual data packets to understand network behavior during the Detection and Analysis phase.
Tool(s) used	Wireshark/ tcpdump
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● Who: A security analyst (myself) monitoring network communications. ● What: Captured and analyzed network packets to inspect packet headers, payloads, and specific protocols (e.g., TCP, HTTP, ICMP). ● When: During routine network monitoring and traffic analysis exercises. ● Where: Within the simulated organizational network environment. ● Why: To gain visibility into network traffic, verify network configurations, and identify potential anomalies or unencrypted sensitive data in transit.
Additional notes	Applying display filters (like filtering for specific IP addresses or protocols) was crucial for quickly isolating relevant packets from massive amounts of network data.

Date: 29/09/2026	Entry 4: Suricata
Description	This entry documents the use of Suricata to examine custom rules, trigger alerts on network traffic, and analyze log outputs (<code>fast.log</code> and <code>eve.json</code>).
Tool(s) used	Suricata (IDS/IPS) and jq command
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: A security analyst (myself) monitoring traffic on the employer's network. • What: Processed a sample packet capture (<code>sample.pcap</code>) using custom Suricata rules to generate alerts for specific HTTP traffic. • When: During routine network monitoring and rule configuration testing. • Where: In a simulated Linux terminal environment, specifically examining files in the <code>/var/log/suricata</code> directory. • Why: To understand how custom signatures evaluate packets and how to extract detailed telemetry data (like <code>flow_id</code> and <code>dest_ip</code>) from JSON logs for incident response.
Additional notes	I learned that while <code>fast.log</code> is good for quick checks, extracting specific fields from <code>eve.json</code> using the <code>jq</code> command is much more effective for correlating network flows.

Date: 29/09/2026	Entry 5: Final report
Description	This entry documents the review of a final incident report regarding a data breach. This occurred during the Post-incident Activity phase to understand the root cause and implemented security controls.
Tool(s) used	Final Incident Report / Documentation
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who: An unknown attacker targeted the retail company's operations. • What: A major security incident involving data theft, where over one million users' data was breached using a forced browsing technique. • When: The incident occurred recently, prior to the start of my current role. • Where: The vulnerability was exploited within the company's e-commerce web application. • Why: The attacker exploited a web application vulnerability to gain unauthorized access and steal sensitive data.
Additional notes	To prevent future recurrences, the organization successfully implemented access control mechanisms and routine vulnerability scans.
